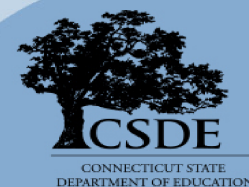


Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2021–22



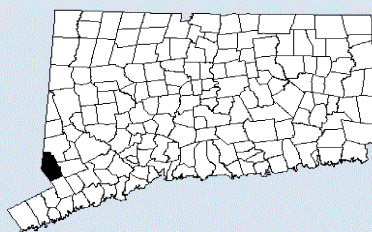
Ridgefield School District

Dr. Susie Dasilva, Superintendent • 203-894-5550 • <http://www.ridgefield.org>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	18
Enrollment	4,578
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$22,355
Total Expenditures ¹	\$102,206,927

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2020-21 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2021-22 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2021 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	*	*	48.5
Male	2,357	51.5	51.5
Non-Binary	*	*	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	0.3
Asian	303	6.6	5.1
Black or African American	32	0.7	12.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	406	8.9	29.0
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	0.1
Two or More Races	199	4.3	4.3
White	3,630	79.3	48.6
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	62	1.4	8.8
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	365	8.0	40.6
Students with Disabilities ³	738	16.1	16.7

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	215	9.8	21	0.9
Male	260	11.2	68	2.8
Non-Binary	0	*	0	*
Black or African American	0	0.0	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	58	14.7	15	3.6
White	371	10.3	69	1.9
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	9	16.1	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	61	19.6	20	5.1
Students with Disabilities	139	19.0	33	3.8
District	475	10.5	89	1.9
State		23.7		6.5

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 186

Number of school-based arrests: 0

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Ridgefield School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	319.3
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	3.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	54.9
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	86.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	10.0
School Level	24.8
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	9.0
Support Staff	3.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	17.5
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	31.6
School Nurses	11.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	225.1

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	4	0.9	1.3
Black or African American	0	0.0	4.3
Hispanic or Latino of any race	9	1.9	4.6
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	1	0.2	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.2
White	454	97.0	89.2

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2020-21

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	8.4	10.4

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	28	87.5	23	82.1
White	271	85.8	295	87.5
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	0	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	23	82.1	22	68.8
Students with Disabilities	43	74.1	35	56.5
District	338	85.4	358	87.7
State		81.7		87.7

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	58	57.4
Emotional Disturbance	35	57.4
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	232	87.5
Other Health Impairment	144	87.8
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	55	96.5
District	534	78.6
State		68.4

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Ridgefield School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	112	2.5	2.3
Emotional Disturbance	61	1.3	1.1
Intellectual Disability	13	0.3	0.6
Learning Disability	266	5.9	6.1
Other Health Impairment	166	3.7	3.3
Other Disabilities	26	0.6	1.1
Speech/Language Impairment	72	1.6	1.9
All Disabilities	716	15.8	16.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	9	1.3	8.2
Private Schools or Other Settings	32	4.5	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2020-21

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$62,330,539	\$13,633	\$12,000
Support services - students	\$7,338,028	\$1,621	\$1,468
Support services - instruction	\$6,161,120	\$1,361	\$780
Support services - general administration	\$1,631,468	\$360	\$472
Support services - school based administration	\$6,096,996	\$1,347	\$1,103
Central and other support services	\$2,265,540	\$500	\$703
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$9,888,983	\$2,184	\$1,910
Student transportation services	\$5,031,666	\$1,094	\$1,287
Food services	.	.	\$28
Enterprise operations	\$1,462,588	\$323	\$170
Total	\$102,206,927	\$22,355	\$19,134

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2020-21

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$6,487,846	31.9	29.7
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$2,292,595	11.3	10.8
Other Salaries	\$1,611,823	7.9	9.8
Employee Benefits	\$3,043,906	15.0	13.8
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$1,105,345	5.4	5.7
Special Education Tuition	\$4,236,022	20.8	22.6
Supplies	\$73,263	0.4	0.6
Property Services	\$5,681	0.0	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$1,450,954	7.1	6.3
Equipment	\$17,202	0.1	0.2
All Other Expenditures	.	.	0.1
Total	\$20,324,637	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		19.9	24.5

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2020-21

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	97.4
State	1.3
Federal	1.3
Tuition & Other	0.1

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Ridgefield School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	*	*
Asian	166	86.1	164	86.5	77	88.9
Black or African American	16	*	15	*	7	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	213	72.6	208	69.2	94	67.5
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	*	*	*	*
Two or More Races	102	84.4	102	80.8	41	79.0
White	1,828	78.8	1,807	74.9	803	73.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	76	69.1	76	70.7	31	72.1
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	2,254	79.3	2,225	75.6	993	74.1
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	156	71.0	151	66.4	67	63.9
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	2,174	79.5	2,150	76.0	957	74.8
Students with Disabilities	361	62.1	357	56.4	150	53.5
Students without Disabilities	1,969	82.0	1,944	78.9	874	77.6
High Needs	527	66.6	521	61.8	221	59.7
Non-High Needs	1,803	82.5	1,780	79.4	803	78.0
District	2,330	78.9	2,301	75.4	1,024	74.0

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at

https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	93.0	91.6	92.4	89.1	1,257	91.5
Curl Up	88.5	97.5	96.8	95.9	1,257	94.5
Push Up	81.5	83.6	83.8	86.1	1,257	83.8
Mile Run/PACER	80.0	94.2	91.7	74.0	1,257	84.4
All Tests - District	65.8	76.7	78.0	66.0	1,257	71.3
All Tests - State	48.9	46.7	44.3	43.3		45.8

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Ridgefield School District

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2020-21	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	32	90.6
White	340	96.8
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	17	*
Students with Disabilities	51	76.5
District	412	95.9
State		89.6

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2020-21 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	*	318	81.3
Male	95.4	*	*
Non-Binary	*	*	*
Black or African American	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino	91.7	36	60.0
White	97.2	480	73.5
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	0	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	90.0	29	48.3
Students with Disabilities	84.2	27	22.5
District	96.9	599	74.5
State	95.0		43.5

³ Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

⁴ Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2021	Class of 2020
	Entrance ⁵	Persistence ⁶
	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Female	90.2	96.0
Male	87.8	94.2
Non-Binary	N/A	N/A
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	83.3	88.9
White	90.1	96.2
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	*	N/A
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	*	*
Students with Disabilities	81.3	84.8
District	89.0	95.2
State	66.1	84.9

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Ridgefield School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	78.9	75	50.0	50	100.0	64.2
	High Needs Students	66.6	75	44.4	50	88.7	54.2
Math Performance Index	All Students	75.4	75	50.0	50	100.0	58.6
	High Needs Students	61.8	75	41.2	50	82.4	47.7
Science Performance Index	All Students	74.0	75	49.4	50	98.7	61.4
	High Needs Students	59.7	75	39.8	50	79.7	51.3
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	65.9%	100%	65.9	100	65.9	60.4%
	High Needs Students	61.6%	100%	61.6	100	61.6	56.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	70.9%	100%	70.9	100	70.9	65.2%
	High Needs Students	62.2%	100%	62.2	100	62.2	59.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	67.5%	100%	33.8	50	67.5	64.9%
	Oral	75.2%	100%	37.6	50	75.2	57.4%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	10.5%	<=5%	39.0	50	78.1	23.7%
	High Needs Students	17.6%	<=5%	24.8	50	49.6	34.0%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	86.6%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	84.8%
	% Meeting Benchmark	74.5%	75%	49.7	50	99.3	43.5%
On-track to High School Graduation		94.1%	94%	50.0	50	100.0	82.7%
4-year Graduation All Students (2021 Cohort)		95.9%	94%	100.0	100	100.0	89.6%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2019 Cohort)		88.6%	94%	94.2	100	94.2	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2021)		89.0%	75%	100.0	100	100.0	66.1%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		89.5% 71.3%	75%	23.8	50	47.5	94.0% 45.8%
Arts Access		41.4%	60%	34.5	50	69.0	52.4%
Accountability Index				1172.8	1450	80.9	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					N
ELA Performance Index Gap	75.0	66.6	8.4	16.6	
Math Performance Index Gap	75.0	61.8	13.2	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	75.0	59.7	15.3	17.4	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	88.6%	5.4%	10.2%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	96.7
	High Needs Students	93.0
Math	All Students	95.5
	High Needs Students	91.8
Science	All Students	94.4
	High Needs Students	88.9

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 67.8

State: 49.7

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Ridgefield School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Ridgefield Public Schools is always seeking to grow ever better in systems, structures, professional learning, engagement, and communication with families. Creating a student-centered, equitable experience for all students continues to be the driving force as the district seeks to educate students to achieve the skills of the RPS Vision of the Graduate.

This drive is evident in the study and implementation of curriculum done in collaboration between Central Office and the schools. For example, this past year we had two Collaborative Action Teams at the elementary level in order to select a new curriculum resource for mathematics and phonics instruction. A common resource will support us in providing an equitable educational experience for all of our students. In addition, a K-12 committee worked on aligning and updating systems and structures connected to intervention across the levels. This looks slightly different as students transition into the high school, but the support is there regardless. All of this work was done with the collaboration of general and special education teachers and all of the upcoming professional learning will also be provided to all teachers and specialists across our schools.

RPS schools at all levels used a variety of strategies to continue to work on social-emotional support and build the bridge from home to the school community. This year we studied the implementation of tools and programs to support social-emotional learning and create a climate in our schools that is inclusive and all students feel that they belong and are able to access learning. The study will result in the addition of some new tools and programs in the fall, as well as further implementation of tools and strategies that schools felt needed a higher level of implementation.

This year communication to families continued to be a priority. RPS continued to provide and update a teacher and parent-facing website, send regular newsletters, and place positive phone calls home. The Superintendent sent out weekly updates and all buildings followed the 24-hour response guideline to connect back with family questions or concerns. New communications came this year in a series of parent workshops, broadcast on our Curriculum YouTube Channel where parents could choose to watch live and submit questions or watch a recorded version at a time that works best for them.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

Ridgefield Public Schools continues to work to reduce isolation, racial, ethnic, economic, or any other type, as the District seeks to bring the mission and vision of the graduate to life for all students. This is evident in different ways across the levels. Students at the elementary level continue to experience classroom libraries that include windows into other cultures and perspectives, as well as mirrors into students' own lives. Students encounter many texts that include positive messages about culture, tolerance, empathy, and kindness. The ever-growing collections reinforce the inclusion and value of all students in RPS. This inclusion is not just evident in libraries, it is also evident in the authors that visit, through the support of the PTAs and the artists that students study in art class. Students learn to value the perspectives of others, navigate and recognize their own emotions as well as those of others, and how to handle conflict.

At the middle school level students continue to engage in learning about different perspectives. We piloted No Place for Hate and will continue this in both middle schools next year. Student learning is focused on curiosity, critical thinking, and questioning, especially in social studies and science instruction that engages in the inquiry cycle. This helps foster empathy and informed citizenship which can positively contribute to our culturally diverse and interdependent world. At the high school, various activities are implemented that collectively qualify the school to obtain the Anti-Defamation League's No Place for Hate (NPFH) designation. We held an interactive assembly program that focused on: understanding bias and prejudice and how to be an ally. In addition to these activities, the annual Man's Inhumanity to Man program was included in the NPFH designation. During the assembly program, 10th and 11th-grade students had the opportunity to hear the first-hand stories of Judith Altmann, a Holocaust survivor after studying about the time period in history class. At both the middle and high school level, staff received professional development from individuals and organizations devoted to supporting schools in creating welcoming and inclusive environments for all students and staff.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2021-22

Ridgefield School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

RPS strives to create a student-centered, equitable experience for all students. This includes the equitable allocation of resources. At each of the levels, systems have been established to ensure this. The Elementary Director and 6-12 Supervisors support the schools in this work by evaluating and revising the curriculum and the MTSS process with teachers and administrators. Consistent class size guidelines, aligned collaborative professional learning across levels, and a push to memorialize curriculum were also done. Initiatives are identified through needs assessments and the curriculum review processes. These studies are clearly communicated and teachers are then supported at the classroom level to ensure consistency and calibration.

Hiring is a collaborative process. This district-wide approach results in high-quality candidates for all schools. At the funding level, RPS continues to use partial resource allocation based upon student enrollment, which provides equity in terms of student funding. Limited Title I and Title II funds are used to supplement the schools, based on a needs assessment and eligibility.